



Chords, cash & custom widgets

How Indian developers are rewriting the App Store playbook

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There is a distinct, electric hum that settles over the global developer community as mid-year approaches. It is the anticipation of Apple's WWDC, an annual ritual where lines of code transform into cultural shifts. While the main event is scheduled to take place between June 8 and 12 in Cupertino, a revolution is playing out thousands of miles away in the tech hubs of India.

These are indie developers, visionaries and siblings turning personal friction points into globally downloaded software. Recently, some of these developers spoke to Times Now Tech, shared their journeys of these apps and more.

Peak

Every software story begins with a problem. For Harshil Shah, a Mumbai-based iOS engineer, that problem arrived in the deafening silence of the 2020 lockdowns. Left alone with the sudden stillness of a pandemic-stricken city, Shah realised his lifestyle had become dangerously sedentary.

His instinctive first step was uniquely tech-centric: he bought an Apple Watch. Just like others, Shah got obsessed with the watch's signature trinity - the move, exercise and stand rings. As time went on, the gamified perfection of the system began to chafe.

"If I go on a hike, if I go play football with my friends, the next day I just won't be able to be as active because maybe I would be tired," Shah explains. "I wanted some more flexibility."

There was a deeper, philosophical disconnect. Simply closing these three circles didn't translate to meaningful long-term health. You could grind out workouts for a month, step onto a scale and watch the numbers refuse to budge.

To bridge this gap between blind discipline and insight, Shah built Peak.

He used Apple's HealthKit platform which allows Peak to upend traditional fitness tracking. Instead of forcing users into a rigid, pre-baked framework, the app acts as an open canvas. Users build their own bespoke health dashboards using modular blocks — charts, trends, goals and totals — all impeccably themed for light and dark modes.

Zoho Notebook

Zoho is by far the biggest and most commonly known name on the list. Almost to the point where it feels kind of unfair to other developers on the list. Part of the reason is Zoho founder Sridhar Vembu's call to support homegrown apps and popularity of some of their products. Coming to Zoho's Notebook, it's a unified platform for voice memos, checklists, scanning documents etc.

It was launched in 2015 as a sleek note-taking alternative and has since blossomed into a comprehensive ecosystem operating seamlessly across iPhone, iPad, Mac and the cutting-edge canvas of Apple Vision Pro.

"We decided to fully go native instead of relying on cross-platform technologies," say Mohideen Sheikh Sulaiman, Principal Architect of Apple Platforms, and Ashok Ramamoorthy, Director of Product Management. By avoiding the slow shortcuts of cross-platform frameworks, Zoho ensures that interaction feels integrated into the ecosystem.

With an army of over 500 iOS developers, Zoho's commitment to privacy